

Quick Insights

Foods to Eat & Foods to Avoid

A condensed scan-friendly companion to the main research PDF. For each food: one-line benefit, top bioactive, and a practical daily/weekly dose. For evidence and references, see 'Diet_for_Male_Infertility_and_Obesity.pdf'.

Educational synthesis. Not medical advice.

Eat (sections 4: food monographs - condensed)

23 foods, sorted by category. Build meals around them.

Walnuts	30 g/day
Best-studied nut for sperm motility & morphology. Key: ALA omega-3, polyphenols, l-arginine, zinc	
Salmon (or sardines, mackerel)	150 g, 2-3x/week
DHA enriches sperm membranes; vitamin D supports testosterone. Key: EPA + DHA, vitamin D, selenium	
Pumpkin seeds	30 g/day
Top plant source of zinc - core mineral for spermatogenesis. Key: Zinc, magnesium, l-arginine	
Brazil nuts	1-2 nuts/day, never more
One nut covers your daily selenium for GPx4 antioxidant defense. Key: Selenium (very high - do not over-eat)	
Eggs	2-3/day acceptable
Cheap high-quality protein with choline + vitamin D. Key: Choline, vitamin D, B12, selenium	
Greek yogurt (0-2% fat, plain)	200 g/day
Satiating protein anchor in a calorie deficit. Key: Casein/whey protein, calcium, probiotics	
Lentils	3+ servings/week
Folate-rich plant protein; lowers sperm aneuploidy risk. Key: Folate, fiber, plant protein, iron	
Chickpeas	3+ servings/week
Resistant starch feeds the gut; improves insulin sensitivity. Key: Folate, manganese, fiber	
Spinach	Daily, lightly cooked
Folate + dietary nitrates - boosts NO and blood flow. Key: Folate, nitrates, magnesium, iron	

Broccoli	200 g, 3+ times/week
Sulforaphane activates Nrf2 antioxidant pathway. Key: Sulforaphane, vitamin C, folate, fiber	
Tomatoes (cooked, with oil)	Daily; cook with olive oil
Lycopene improves motility & morphology in RCTs. Key: Lycopene, vitamin C, potassium	
Pomegranate	150 g arils/day or 200 mL juice
Punicalagins reduce seminal lipid peroxidation. Key: Punicalagins, urolithins, anthocyanins	
Berries	100-150 g/day
Anthocyanins protect endothelium and sperm DNA. Key: Anthocyanins, vitamin C, fiber	
Oats (rolled or steel-cut)	60 g dry/day
Beta-glucan flattens glucose spikes; aids satiety. Key: Beta-glucan, magnesium, zinc	
Extra virgin olive oil	2-3 tbsp/day
Replace butter/refined seed oil; oleocanthal is anti-inflammatory. Key: Oleic acid, oleocanthal, vitamin E, polyphenols	
Avocado	1/2 fruit/day
Mono-unsaturated fat + 7 g fiber; lifts HDL quality. Key: Oleic acid, fiber, potassium, folate	
Green tea	2-3 cups/day
EGCG - antioxidant + mild thermogenic effect. Key: EGCG, L-theanine, caffeine	
Dark chocolate (>=85%)	10-20 g/day max
Cocoa flavanols improve endothelial function. Key: Flavanols, magnesium	
Whole grains (barley, bulgur, rye)	Default starch at meals
Stable energy; supports microbiome diversity. Key: Fiber, B vitamins, magnesium, zinc	
Tofu / tempeh / edamame	1-3 servings/week
Whole-food soy is safe for testosterone in normal amounts. Key: Soy protein, isoflavones, calcium	
Skinless chicken / turkey breast	Several times/week
Lean protein anchor; preserves muscle in a deficit. Key: Protein 31 g/100 g, niacin, B6, selenium	
Garlic & onion	Daily in cooking
Allium organosulfurs lower BP & lipids modestly. Key: Allicin, S-allyl cysteine, quercetin	
Water / unsweetened tea	2-3 L total fluid/day
Replacing one daily soda is the biggest single win. Key: Hydration; 0 kcal	

Avoid or limit (section 5)

Frequency is the lever - occasional intake is fine; daily/weekly habits are the problem.

Sugar-sweetened beverages

Why: Each daily 250 mL serving is linked to lower sperm motility and weight gain.

Swap: Replace with water, sparkling water, or unsweetened tea.

Processed & cured meats

Why: Bacon, sausage, hot dogs, deli meats - linked to lower sperm morphology.

Swap: Use fish, eggs, legumes, or fresh poultry instead.

Trans-fat foods

Why: Industrial partially hydrogenated oils accumulate in seminal lipids.

Swap: Read labels; avoid 'partially hydrogenated' anything.

Deep-fried fast food

Why: High energy density, oxidised fats, low micronutrients.

Swap: Reserve for rare occasions, not weekly habit.

Refined grains & added sugar

Why: Drive insulin resistance, which impairs Leydig cell function.

Swap: Swap white bread/rice for whole grains; cap added sugar at 25 g/day.

High-mercury fish

Why: King mackerel, swordfish, shark, tilefish, big-eye tuna.

Swap: Choose salmon, sardines, anchovies, trout, light tuna.

Excess alcohol

Why: >7 drinks/week dose-dependently lowers sperm parameters.

Swap: Ideally abstain during preconception.

High-dose soy isoflavone supplements

Why: Whole-food soy is fine; isolated mega-dose isoflavones are not.

Swap: Skip 'fertility' products with concentrated isoflavones.

Tobacco, vaping, daily cannabis, anabolic steroids

Why: Highest-impact non-food modifiable harms after weight.

Swap: Quitting is the single biggest fertility intervention available.

End of quick-insight summary. For full nutrition tables, mechanisms, 7-day plan, 12-week protocol, and references, see [Diet_for_Male_Infertility_and_Obesity.pdf](#) in this folder.